CYBERCAB FLEET OWNERS · PUBLIC EDITION

# The Economics of a Cybercab

## What every kilometre costs an owner , and which assumptions move it most

Version 2.1 · Oct 31, 2026

Written by the expert team of the Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners community , based on the analysis of Cern Basher and AJ ( @alojoh )

cybercabfleetowners.com

Independent community, not affiliated with Tesla, Inc.

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**Where this comes from**

This guide is built on the interview If You Buy a CYBERCAB How Much MONEY Could You Make ? on Brighter with Herbert ( Herbert Ong , 21 Feb 2026 , 1 h 12 min ) , https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wftOjQgleu0 , with analyst Cern Basher , and on his X article If you Purchase a Cybercab how Much Money can you Make ? ( 18 Feb 2026 ) https://x.com/CernBasher/status/2024241623883034965 and his follow-up post Tesla Robotaxi Take Rate : What's Optimal ? ( 19 Feb 2026 ) https://x.com/CernBasher/status/2024510824132297154 , and his X article Building Your Cybercab Fleet ( 9 Mar 2026 ) https://x.com/CernBasher/status/2030979224819900515 . Version 2.0 adds chapter 9 , built on AJ ( @alojoh ) in the interview EXCLUSIVE : Tesla Analyst Drops SHOCKING Valuation Forecast on Brighter with Herbert ( 11 May 2025 ) , minute 56 to 1:12 , https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pXz8Z9JrzBA . All model figures are the analysts' assumptions and estimates , paraphrased .

**Before you read**

Not financial advice . Tesla has not published owner terms , prices or fees . This edition contains no earnings , return , revenue , fee or price figures .

CHAPTER 1

# From wage to machine

Why the car becomes an asset

*An Uber driver trades hours for money . An Airbnb host deals with guests and cleaning at odd hours . A Cybercab owner , in Cern Basher's framing , does neither : the car joins a network and works while the owner sleeps . That idea is attractive , and that is exactly why the costs deserve a careful look .*

**What this chapter covers**
Why Tesla might sell cars to owners at all · The shift from labour to capital · The one metric to watch

This chapter covers why owner cars may exist , what changes when a car becomes a productive asset , and why cost per kilometre is the number to watch .

**Proof point 1 : peaks and troughs**
Ride demand peaks in the morning and evening · A fleet sized for peaks sits idle overnight

Ride demand has sharp peaks and deep night-time troughs , as New Street Research data shown in the video illustrates . Basher argues Tesla can run a base fleet around the clock and let owner cars add capacity at the peaks , which lowers how much capital Tesla itself must tie up .

**Proof point 2 : capital and allies**
Selling cars recycles capital · Many owners spread the benefit , and the political support

Selling cars lets Tesla recycle capital and run factories at full capacity . Spreading ownership also creates many owners with a stake in the network , which Basher sees as protection against political pressure .

**Proof point 3 : home charging and placement**
Distributed home charging eases Supercharger load · Cars start the day spread across the city

Cars that charge at owners' homes reduce the need for new chargers , and they start the morning spread through the city instead of queuing out of one depot .

## Cost per km

The one metric in this guide · measured over all kilometres , paid and empty

**Wider than robotaxis**
Like a rental property , but the asset wears out · The same logic may reach vans , trucks and other

> robots

Basher compares it to the rental property market : for the first time a vehicle can be bought on its expected use . Unlike a building , the car wears out , so depreciation per kilometre is central to everything that follows .

> **Discuss this chapter**
> Bring your own numbers to the Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners community on X : https://x.com/i/communities/1912893645050511710

CHAPTER 2

# Buying and financing the car

Purchase , loan and what a lender looks at

*Two buyers order the same car . One pays cash , one borrows almost all of it . On day one their cars are identical . By year three their cost per kilometre is not , because financing is a cost line too .*

> **What this chapter covers**
> The purchase and its likely conditions · Financing as a fixed yearly cost · How lenders may judge the asset

This chapter covers the purchase , how financing enters your cost per kilometre , and how a lender may look at a car that earns on a network .

> **Proof point 1 : conditions may come attached**
> Possible minimum network hours · Personal use may be priced differently

Basher expects Tesla to attach conditions to owner sales , for example a minimum number of hours in the network each month , because a car parked in a driveway does not help the network . Personal-only use may cost more in software fees .

> **Proof point 2 : financing is fixed , depreciation is not**
> Financing cost stays the same whatever you drive · Depreciation rises with kilometres driven

In his model financing is a fixed yearly cost , while the vehicle cost , depreciation , grows with mileage because a car that drives more reaches the end of its battery life sooner . He assumes a battery life of about 600,000 miles ( about 965,000 km ) , on the careful side .

> **Proof point 3 : the lender's view**
> Credit may follow the asset , not only the borrower · Asset-backed markets already exist

He suggests lenders may judge the car's network income more than the borrower's salary , as with asset-backed securities . Until owner terms exist , expect lenders to ask for your own careful case .

> **Deep dive : depreciation depends on funding**
> The largest cost line · Cash · loan · lease · pooled fleet · Residual-value risk sits with different parties

The same expert business plan puts depreciation ahead of every running cost , and notes that its size depends on the funding structure . A buyer with a loan carries the full loss of value plus interest ; a

lease or pooled fleet moves part of the residual-value risk to someone else , at a price . Choose the funding route before fixing your cost per kilometre .

> **The funding plan solution**
> Write off over 8 to 10 years , not a 4-year lease · Fund the self-driving part separately · Fund on cash flows , not residual value · Keep the purchase cost low

Michiel van Duijn presented the expert team's solution in Robotaxi Countdown episode 39 ( youtube.com/watch?v=2GpLG7RqqTk ) : spread the write-off over the car's real life , fund the self-driving part with investors who share its upside , and fund robotaxis on future cash flows with asset-based interest plus a share of ride income , so the car repays its own loan . A used car is never worth more than a new one , so a low purchase price matters too . See our separate Funding and Depreciation guide .

> **Discuss this chapter**
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CHAPTER 3

# The cost per kilometre , line by line

Energy , insurance , cleaning , maintenance , depreciation , platform share

*Ask a new owner what the car costs and they name the loan payment . Ask again after a year and they name tyres , insurance and the electricity bill . The cost per kilometre is all of those lines , divided by every kilometre the car drives .*

**What this chapter covers**
The ten cost lines in Basher's model · Fixed versus variable costs · His cost per km range

This chapter covers each cost line , which ones are fixed and which grow with use , and the cost per kilometre that comes out .

| Cost line | How Basher models it | Type |
|---|---|---|
| Energy ( charging ) | Home charging at about $0.16 per kWh in the base case , about $0.35 when using fast chargers | Variable |
| Insurance | Physical damage paid by the owner ; he expects Tesla to carry liability | Fixed |
| Cleaning | Zero in the base case ( owner cleans ) ; paid if Tesla or a provider does it | Variable |
| Tyres and maintenance | Rises with kilometres , one of the biggest variable lines | Variable |
| Depreciation ( vehicle cost ) | Purchase spread over battery life | Variable |
| Financing | Interest on the loan | Fixed |
| Autonomy software | Monthly FSD subscription | Fixed |
| Parking | Zero on a private driveway , paid in cities | Fixed |
| Taxes and other | EV road taxes and fees , differ by state or country | Fixed |
| Platform share | Tesla's share of every fare | % of fares |

**Proof point 1 : tyres are a big line**
Heavy daily mileage wears tyres fast · A slow , city-only design may help

Tyres and maintenance are among the largest lines . The Cybercab is built for city speeds with gentle acceleration and cornering , which may reduce wear , but daily inspections will still be needed .

**Proof point 2 : insurance splits in two**
Liability : expected with Tesla · Physical damage : with the owner

He expects Tesla to take the liability side , leaving the owner to insure damage to the car itself . That is an assumption until owner terms are published .

# $0.23 to $0.32 per mile

Basher's modelled cost over all miles , paid and empty · about $0.14 to $0.20 per km · falling as utilisation rises

**Proof point 3 : cost per km falls with use**
Fixed costs spread over more kilometres · Variable costs stay roughly flat per kilometre

His modelled cost falls from about 20 to 14 US cents per kilometre as the car moves from 30% to 65% utilisation , because fixed lines are spread over more kilometres . These are his estimates , in US conditions , and exclude the platform share .

**Wider than the car**
Parking , cleaning and marketing were set near zero · For a small fleet , add them back

His base case sets parking , cleaning and marketing close to zero for a home owner . A fleet with a depot , paid cleaning and its own staff must add these lines back , which is why chapter 6 of our implementation guide builds careful , middle and hopeful cases .

## A second view : ten cost drivers per mile , by AJ ( @alojoh )

| Cost driver | Key inputs | ¢ per mile | ¢ per km | Share |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Depreciation | Vehicle $21K · 4-year life · 313K mi total | 7.2 | 4.5 | 45.5 % |
| Cleaning | Every 345 mi · $11.4 per clean | 3.3 | 2.1 | 20.7 % |
| Electricity | 18 kWh per 100 mi · 13.2 ¢ per kWh | 2.4 | 1.5 | 15.0 % |
| Interior refurbishment | $815 per 80K mi | 1.0 | 0.6 | 6.4 % |
| Tires and wheels | $255 per 30K mi | 0.8 | 0.5 | 5.3 % |
| Insurance equivalent | $204 a year per 15K mi , 50% discount | 0.6 | 0.4 | 3.6 % |
| Wipers | $15 per 10K mi | 0.2 | 0.1 | 1.0 % |
| Brakes | $102 per 80K mi ( regenerative braking ) | 0.1 | 0.1 | 0.8 % |
| Air filter and AC | $36 per 40K mi | 0.1 | 0.1 | 0.5 % |
| All other | $51 per 30K mi | 0.2 | 0.1 | 1.1 % |
| **Total** | **Forecast for Q1 2027** | **15.9** | **9.9** | **100 %** |

Notes from the source : cost per mile is per mile driven , meaning total miles including empty miles , not paid miles · the forecast includes 2.5 % yearly inflation · vehicle cost , cleaning and electricity together make up more than 80 % of the cost per mile . Kilometre values converted by us ( ÷ 1.609 ) . Source : AJ ( @alojoh ) , Tesla Ride Hailing Cost Drivers , Part 1 , Cost per Mile Driven , based on company filings , 8 May 2025 . Figures are his estimates for a Tesla-operated fleet , in US dollars .

**Deep dive : cleaning and charging**
Cleaning ≈ 20% of operating cost per km · Charging ≈ 15% · Together ≈ 35% , the biggest running costs after depreciation

An expert business plan for operating and funding a Cybercab fleet reaches a different conclusion from the video on one point : cleaning is not close to zero . It estimates cleaning at about 20 percent and charging at about 15 percent of total operating cost per kilometre , together about 35 percent , making them the largest running costs after depreciation . With no driver to tidy up , cleaning frequency , labour

and depot set-up decide this line , and shared depots and crews lower both . Never model cleaning at zero .

> **Incremental cost per mile : three cars compared**
> Waymo : about $1 per mile · Model 3 used as a robotaxi : about $0.70 · Cybercab : about $0.20

A simple comparison from @fminderop on X ( x.com/fminderop/status/1894774338164797539 , Feb 2025 ) puts the incremental cost per mile of a Waymo at about one dollar , a Model 3 used as a robotaxi at about 70 cents and a Cybercab at about 20 cents . These are rough estimates of cost , not prices or earnings , but they show why a purpose-built , low-cost car changes the economics . Riders judge a service on price per mile and wait time , so the lowest cost per mile gives the most room .

> **Discuss this chapter**
> Bring your own numbers to the Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners community on X : https://x.com/i/communities/1912893645050511710

CHAPTER 4

# Utilisation and empty kilometres

How busy the car is decides almost everything

*Two identical cars sit in the same city . One drives seven hours a day , the other fifteen . Their costs per year differ by less than you think . Their costs per kilometre differ a lot .*

**What this chapter covers**
What utilisation means · Empty kilometres · Rural versus city

This chapter covers what utilisation means in practice , how empty kilometres raise your cost , and how the picture changes outside the city .

**Proof point 1 : utilisation is time with a rider**
30% = about 7.2 hours a day in service · 65% = about 15.6 hours a day

Basher defines utilisation as time actually in service , not time available . A car can be on the network all day and still reach only 30% on a slow day . At 30% he estimates about 18 to 19 trips and 157 miles ( about 250 km ) a day , within one home charge .

**Proof point 2 : empty kilometres**
Base case : 40% of all miles are empty · Rural case : 100% , every trip returns empty

He assumes 40% of all miles carry no rider , repositioning and driving to pick-ups , higher than the 35% estimate cited in our implementation guide . In his rural case every trip returns empty . Each empty kilometre still costs energy , tyres and depreciation .

**Proof point 3 : dwell time**
About 3 minutes to load and unload · Waiting riders may be charged per minute

Loading and unloading take about three minutes per trip in his model . He suggests charging riders who stay in the car , for example during a call , as if it were still driving .

## 40%

Share of all miles that are empty in Basher's base case · his assumption

**Wider than one car**
Revenue pooling by area may reduce placement luck

He raises the idea that owners might share in the earnings of their area , so a car parked in the wrong place on a quiet night is not penalised . Tesla has not said how it will work .

> **Utilisation : longer hours and bigger zones**
> Service now runs 6am to 2am · Houston zone grew from 25 to 254 square miles · More hours and more area : more paid miles per car

From @fminderop on X ( x.com/fminderop/status/2116066055269548114 , 30 Oct 2026 ) : the Robotaxi service now runs from 6am to 2am , and the Houston zone grew from 25 to 254 square miles . Longer hours and a bigger area mean more paid miles per car and fewer empty kilometres between rides . As a community member put it , a parked Cybercab is a garage ornament : utilisation drives everything else in this guide .

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CHAPTER 5

# The levers Tesla controls

Car price , software fee and platform share

*Imagine you run pricing at Tesla . You can change three dials : what the car costs , what the software costs each month and what share of every fare you keep . Turn one up and you can turn another down . Every owner's cost per kilometre depends on where those dials end up .*

**What this chapter covers**
The three dials · Dynamic pricing · What fairness between Tesla and owners means

This chapter covers the three levers Tesla controls , why fares will likely be dynamic , and how Basher tests whether a split is fair to both sides .

**Proof point 1 : Tesla is hiring for dynamic pricing**
A robotaxi pricing role · Surge pricing , taxes , tolls , regional factors

A Tesla job posting for robotaxi pricing describes models for dynamic and surge pricing that include base cost , taxes , fees , tolls , demand and location . Pricing balances supply and demand , which keeps wait times short .

**Proof point 2 : the dials trade off**
Lower software fee , higher platform share · Or the other way round

Basher shows Tesla could give the software away and keep a larger share of fares , or charge a high monthly fee and keep a smaller share , and land in a similar place . Volume discounts for owners with several cars are another possible lever .

**Proof point 3 : the fairness test**
Compare owner and Tesla gross profit per car · A split that is far off either way is unlikely to last

In his take-rate post he compares what the owner and Tesla each keep per car . His view : the split that looks fair to both sides sits in a fairly narrow band , and it shifts with fare levels and software fees .

## 3 dials

Car price · software fee · platform share · all unknown until Tesla publishes owner terms

**Wider than Tesla**
Today's rideshare prices are far above the costs Tesla targets

Tesla's stated targets of roughly 25 to 30 US cents per mile are costs , not prices , as the video stresses . Fares will be set by the market , competition and regulation .

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CHAPTER 6

# Sensitivity : which assumptions matter most

Run your careful , middle and hopeful case

*Every model gives the answer its assumptions allow . Basher says so himself : it is easy to get a desired outcome by tweaking a few inputs . The useful question is not what the answer is , but which inputs move it most .*

**What this chapter covers**
The inputs that move the result · What to test first · How to use this with the implementation guide

This chapter covers which assumptions matter most , in what order to test them , and how to put them into your own cost sheet .

| Assumption | Base case | Tested | Effect on owner costs or margin |
|---|---|---|---|
| Utilisation | 30% to 65% | 30% to 65% | Biggest single driver ; cost per km falls as fixed costs spread |
| Empty kilometres | 40% | Up to 100% ( rural ) | More empty km , more cost per paid km |
| Energy price | Home charging | Fast charging | Higher energy line , modest overall effect |
| Software fee | Monthly subscription | Free to high | Can wipe out the owner margin at a high platform share |
| Platform share | Mid-range | Low to half of fares | Very large effect on what remains for costs |
| Battery life | 600,000 miles | Up to 1 million | Longer life lowers depreciation per km |
| Fare level | Low , Austin-style | Up to double | Strongest effect on viability ; not shown in this edition |

**Proof point 1 : utilisation first**
Fixed costs are about half the yearly total · Low use means high cost per km

Because financing , insurance , software and taxes are largely fixed , a quiet car carries a high cost per kilometre .

**Proof point 2 : software fee and platform share together**
Test them as a pair

In his take-rate post a high software fee combined with a high platform share leaves the owner with nothing to cover costs . Always test the two together .

> **Proof point 3 : local costs**
> Energy , taxes , parking and insurance vary by place

His model uses US home-owner costs . European or other local energy , insurance , parking and road taxes can be very different , so replace each line with a local quote .

# Careful case first

Low utilisation · high empty share · paid cleaning and parking · fast charging

> **Wider than the model**
> Extra revenue layers were left out on purpose

He modelled trips only , leaving out delivery , advertising and in-car services . They may come , but plan without them .

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CHAPTER 7

# Risks and what to watch

What could change the numbers

*The first owners will buy before anyone has real data . That is the opportunity and the risk in one sentence .*

**What this chapter covers**
The main risks · The signals to watch · Where to discuss them

This chapter lists the risks that matter most for cost per kilometre and the signals that will tell you whether the assumptions hold .

**Risk 1 : owner terms**
Platform share , software fee , minimum hours · Insurance split , pooling rules

Nothing in this guide is confirmed by Tesla . Owner terms decide most cost lines .

**Risk 2 : utilisation and placement**
Tesla's own base fleet may take the busiest hours · Owner cars may serve peaks only

If owner cars mainly cover peaks , utilisation may be lower than in a car that runs all day . Watch how dispatch treats owner cars .

**Risk 3 : wear , regulation and competition**
Tyres , cleaning and damage from heavy use · Local permits , taxes and insurance rules · Falling fares as supply grows

Heavy use wears cars faster than private driving . Rules and taxes differ by city and country . As more cars join , fares may fall , and the early picture may not last .

**Risk 4 : source bias**
Model by one analyst · Optimistic framing in the video

The video and posts present one analyst's model in an enthusiastic interview . The host and guest disclose they hold Tesla shares . Treat the figures as a starting point , not evidence .

## Signals to watch

Published owner terms · measured empty-km share of early fleets · real insurance quotes · local energy prices

**What it means for your plan**
Build the cost sheet now , fill in facts as they arrive · Not financial advice

Use the cost lines in this guide , add your local quotes and run a careful case before you order a car . This guide describes costs , not investments . Not financial advice .

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CHAPTER 8

# Growing a fleet from one car

Reinvesting , and what slows it down

*Someone with modest savings buys one car . Every month its spare cash goes into a pot , and whenever the pot covers a down payment another car is ordered . In Cern Basher's article Building Your Cybercab Fleet , that simple rule turns one car into a fleet within a few years . The idea is powerful . The limits are where the real work is .*

**What this chapter covers**
How reinvestment compounds · Which inputs drive the speed · The constraints he lists himself

This chapter covers his reinvestment scenario , the inputs that make it fast or slow , and the real-world limits an owner must plan for .

**Proof point 1 : slow , then fast**
Year one : a handful of cars · Then growth accelerates

Growth starts slowly because only one car contributes . Each new car adds to the pot , so purchases speed up over time . He runs it on his individual-owner model including all expenses , at a low 30% utilisation , with a down payment per car and a bank loan for the rest .

**Proof point 2 : one input changes everything**
Fare level · utilisation · loan terms · Compounding magnifies small differences

Changing a single input , in his case the base fare , changes the outcome dramatically . The same compounding works against you : lower utilisation , higher insurance or higher energy prices slow growth just as strongly .

**Proof point 3 : the constraints**
Tesla's supply and willingness to sell · Parking , depots and local rules · Lender appetite

He warns not to take the projection to the bank . It assumes unlimited cars from Tesla and ignores where cars park , as he jokes , more than your homeowners' association allows .

## Cost per km per car

The test for every next car · fleet costs such as depot , cleaning and staff appear as you grow

**Wider than one owner**

> The same logic drives pooled fleets · Staged growth on real data

The same reinvestment logic is how pooled fleets would grow . In practice , grow in stages and fund each next car only after earlier cars show real cost and use data . Not financial advice .

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CHAPTER 9

# AJ's cost model explained

Cost per mile driven versus cost per paid mile

*Two analysts use the same cost table . One divides by every mile the car drives , the other only by the miles a rider pays for . Their answers can differ by a factor of two . In a Brighter with Herbert interview , analyst AJ ( @alojoh ) walks through his ride-hailing cost model and explains why that difference decides who wins the robotaxi market .*

**What this chapter covers**
Cost per mile driven and cost per paid mile · Empty miles as a key driver · Why vehicle cost still matters per mile · Depreciation and cleaning : two-thirds of the cost

This chapter paraphrases AJ's explanation from minute 56 to 1:12 of the interview EXCLUSIVE : Tesla Analyst Drops SHOCKING Valuation Forecast ( Brighter with Herbert , 11 May 2025 ) , https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pXz8Z9JrzBA , and connects it to his cost table in chapter 3 .

| Cost driver | Key inputs | ¢ per mile | ¢ per km | Share |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Depreciation | Vehicle $21K · 4-year life · 313K mi total | 7.2 | 4.5 | 45.5 % |
| Cleaning | Every 345 mi · $11.4 per clean | 3.3 | 2.1 | 20.7 % |
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| **Total** | **Forecast for Q1 2027** | **15.9** | **9.9** | **100 %** |

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**Proof point 1 : two different costs per mile ( 56:30 )**
Cost per mile driven : every mile , paid or empty · Cost per paid mile : what each paid mile must carry

AJ separates the cost per mile driven , the 15.9 US cents in his table , from the cost per paid mile . His example : a rider travels four miles , but with 20% empty miles the car drives five . The cost of all five

miles has to be carried by the four that are paid for .

**Proof point 2 : empty miles are a key driver ( 58:00 )**
Starts high : about 50% empty miles in his model · Falls as density , adoption and network effects grow · Cost per paid mile = cost per mile driven ÷ paid share

He assumes about half of all miles are empty at launch , because density and customer adoption are low for a new service . As network effects kick in he expects the share to fall , below what is seen in key markets today . To get the cost per paid mile , divide the cost per mile driven by the paid share of miles . He warns that projections which ignore this step are completely off .

# ≈ 31.8 ¢ per paid mile

Our arithmetic on AJ's figures : 15.9 ¢ per mile driven ÷ 50% paid share at launch · about 19.8 ¢ per paid km · halves as empty miles approach zero

**Proof point 3 : vehicle cost shows up per mile ( 1:00:00 )**
Low production cost : two seats , small , light · No expensive sensor suite · A short 4-year useful life , over 300,000 miles

AJ sees the low production cost as the Cybercab's main strength , next to the software . He rejects the argument that vehicle price is irrelevant because it is spread over 10 or 15 years : it still appears in the cost per mile . He models a short four-year life because the cars drive so much , and riders do not accept old or dirty cars ; successful European rental firms replace cars every two to three years .

**Proof point 4 : depreciation and cleaning ( 1:03:30 )**
Depreciation 7.2 ¢ per mile , about 45% of cost · Depreciation plus cleaning : almost two-thirds · Interior refurbishment at least every 80,000 miles

With a proper depreciation schedule he arrives at 7.2 US cents per mile for depreciation , about 45% of the total . Together with cleaning it makes up almost two-thirds of the cost . This , he argues , is why Tesla showed a cleaning robot before the Cybercab launched , and why the seats are designed to be easy to clean with almost no stitching . This matches the deep dive in chapter 3 : never model cleaning at zero .

**Proof point 5 : cost is the lasting advantage ( 1:05:30 )**
Competitive self-driving software will arrive elsewhere · Cost per mile decides the ride-hailing contest · Network effects , as with the Supercharger network

AJ expects competitors to reach competitive self-driving software in some markets as compute gets cheaper . The lasting advantage is cost per mile , built into the vehicle , combined with network effects . Owner cars are modelled separately in his work , as a software business where the owner looks after cleaning and Tesla matches supply and demand for a cut .

**What it means for an owner**
Know your cost per mile driven · Then divide by your expected paid share · Budget depreciation

> and cleaning first

Start from a cost per kilometre driven , like the 9.9 cents in AJ's table , then convert it to a cost per paid kilometre using a careful empty-km share for your area . Depreciation and cleaning deserve the most attention . His figures are for a Tesla-operated fleet in US dollars ; an owner car adds financing , insurance , parking and the platform share , see chapters 2 and 3 .

> **Discuss this chapter**
> Bring your own numbers to the Tesla Cybercab Fleet Owners community on X :
> https://x.com/i/communities/1912893645050511710

## Changelog

- **v2.1 · Oct 31, 2026** : chapter 3 : incremental cost per mile compared for Waymo , a Model 3 and the Cybercab ; chapter 4 : utilisation , longer service hours and the Houston zone growing from 25 to 254 square miles . Both from @fminderop on X .
- **v2.0 · Oct 31, 2026** : new chapter 9 , AJ's cost model explained , from his Brighter with Herbert interview ( minute 56 to 1:12 ) : cost per mile driven versus cost per paid mile , empty miles , vehicle cost and a 4-year life , depreciation and cleaning . Sources and credits updated .
- **v1.0 · Oct 31, 2026** : first edition , based on Cern Basher , AJ's cost table , an expert business plan and Robotaxi Countdown episode 39 .

JOIN US

# Work out your own cost per kilometre with the community

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Sources : the interview If You Buy a CYBERCAB How Much MONEY Could You Make ? on the YouTube channel Brighter with Herbert ( @BrighterwithHerbert , host Herbert Ong , 21 Feb 2026 ) , https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wftOjQgleu0 ; Cern Basher ( @CernBasher ) , X article If you Purchase a Cybercab how Much Money can you Make ? ( 18 Feb 2026 ) , https://x.com/CernBasher/status/2024241623883034965 ; and his post Tesla Robotaxi Take Rate : What's Optimal ? ( 19 Feb 2026 ) , https://x.com/CernBasher/status/2024510824132297154 ; Cern Basher , X article Building Your Cybercab Fleet ( 9 Mar 2026 ) , https://x.com/CernBasher/status/2030979224819900515 . The cost driver table in chapter 3 rebuilds a slide by AJ ( @alojoh ) , Tesla Ride Hailing Cost Drivers ( 8 May 2025 ) , based on company filings . Chapter 9 paraphrases AJ ( @alojoh ) in EXCLUSIVE : Tesla Analyst Drops SHOCKING Valuation Forecast , Brighter with Herbert , 11 May 2025 , minute 56 to 1:12 , https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pXz8Z9JrzBA ; the per paid mile figure is our arithmetic on his numbers . The funding plan solution in chapter 2 paraphrases Michiel van Duijn , Robotaxi Countdown episode 39 , youtube.com/watch?v=2GpLG7RqqTk . The deep dives on cleaning , charging and depreciation in chapters 2 and 3 draw on an expert business plan for operating and funding a Cybercab fleet , written by members of the expert team . All other model assumptions and estimates are theirs , paraphrased . Miles converted to kilometres by us . Not financial advice . Tesla has not published owner terms , prices or fees . This edition contains no earnings , return , revenue , fee or price figures . Independent community, not affiliated with Tesla, Inc.